

GALE ENCYCLOPEDIA OF MEDICINE
HYPERTENSION (HIGH BLOOD PRESSURE)

Definition: Hypertension is a chronic medical condition characterized by persistent elevation of arterial blood pressure.

Causes and Pathophysiology: Primary or essential hypertension accounts for approximately 90 to 95 percent of cases.

Symptoms and Clinical Manifestations: Hypertension is famously referred to as the silent killer because most individuals have no symptoms.

Management and Lifestyle Approaches: Non-pharmacological management includes sodium restriction, adherence to a healthy diet, regular exercise, and stress management.

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MIGRAINE HEADACHE DISORDERS

Definition: Migraine is a complex neurological disorder characterized by recurrent attacks of moderate to severe unilateral

Symptoms and Clinical Presentation: Common symptoms include severe pulsating pain usually focused on one side of the head

Etiology and Triggers: Cortical spreading depression is considered the underlying neurophysiological substrate of migraine

Evidence-Based Management: Acute pharmacotherapy includes triptans, NSAIDs, and antiemetics. Preventive interventions include

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ANXIETY DISORDERS AND PANIC RESPONSES

Definition: Anxiety disorders encompass psychiatric conditions characterized by excessive, persistent, and uncontro

Physiological and Somatic Manifestations: Autonomic nervous system hyperarousal produces rapid tachycardia, ta

Evidence-Based Coping and Stabilization: Paced breathing techniques (such as 4-second box breathing) actively st

Clinical Care and Assessment: Persistent generalized anxiety disorder (GAD) or panic disorder responds effectively

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INSOMNIA AND CIRCADIAN RHYTHM DISORDERS

Definition: Insomnia involves persistent difficulty initiating sleep, maintaining sleep continuity, or experiencing non-re

Etiological Factors and Mechanisms: Hyperarousal of the central nervous system, elevated evening cortisol levels, a

Sleep Hygiene and Cognitive Interventions: Recommended behavioral practices include maintaining strict regular w

Medical Evaluation: Chronic sleep disruption exceeding three months should be evaluated by a healthcare specialis

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ABDOMINAL PAIN AND GASTROINTESTINAL DISORDERS

Definition: Abdominal pain, commonly experienced as stomach ache, localized cramping, or visceral discomfort, is p

Common Causes and the Brain-Gut Axis: Common benign and functional etiologies include dyspepsia (indigestion),

Clinical Warning Signs (Red Flags): While many stomach aches are self-limiting, certain symptoms indicate severe r

Educational Guidance and Assessment: Mild functional stomach discomfort often improves with rest, adequate hydr